


# Parent Handbook

2026-2027

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## SECTION 1: GENERAL INFORMATION FOR PARENTS

### WELCOME

The Rockwood Nursery School Parent Handbook has been developed to support the relationship between our teachers and parents by providing information about our school. It includes our philosophy, goals, expectations for parents, and relevant policies and procedures. Please note that a copy of our By-laws (Charter) will be posted at the entrance of the school to ensure all parents have access to this information.

### MISSION STATEMENT

We strive to provide high-quality education and childcare in a safe, respectful, and inclusive environment that builds a foundation for lifelong learning.

### VISION STATEMENT & VALUES

- To be a place where every child feels loved, respected, and empowered to reach their full potential.
- To create a community where children, families, and staff feel a sense of belonging, where every child is valued and respected, and where learning is celebrated.
- Our focus is to provide a stimulating early learning and child care experience that promotes each child's social, emotional, physical, and cognitive development.

### ORIENTATION FOR PARENTS

In early September, we will offer an Orientation Meeting for parents to attend, preferably without children. At the Orientation Meeting, the Supervisor will present key policies and procedures, introduce you to the school and its programs, and answer any questions you may have.

**Our Fall Orientation Meeting will be held on Wednesday September 9th, 2026 at 7:00 p.m. at Rockwood Nursery School.**

### BEING PART OF A CO-OPERATIVE NURSERY SCHOOL

As a Co-operative Nursery School, the continuation of our programs depends on parental involvement. Parents are expected to fulfill their responsibilities as members of our school, which allows us to effectively deliver quality programming to your child.

One parent from each family will be asked to serve on one committee and complete one school cleaning night over the course of the school year. Committee sign-up takes place on Orientation Night, and cleaning nights will be assigned at the beginning of the school year. Commitment to these responsibilities is essential to the success of our school.

One parent is also required to attend the September Orientation Meeting and the spring Annual General Meeting (date TBD). The Annual General Meeting is critical to the success of the school and provides an opportunity to contribute to school operations, elect a new Board of Directors, review the financial standing of the current year, and discuss concerns or opportunities for the future.
Parents are welcome to participate in and/or visit the program at any time. If you would like to volunteer, including joining our Board of Directors, please let us know!

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## OUR TEACHERS

Our teaching team—Ashley Cypcarz, Nicki Barens, Christine Miron, and Krista Petty—are enthusiastic and dedicated individuals with the best interests of the children in mind. Ashley, Nicki, and Christine are Registered Early Childhood Educators with years of experience. Our teachers are always happy to speak with you if you need information or have questions.

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## HOURS OF OPERATION

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| GROUP A:<br>2.5- 4 yrs | MONDAY, WEDNESDAY, FRIDAY | 9:00am-<br>11:30am | TEACHERS: Nicki, Christine and Krista |
| GROUP B:<br>1.5-2.5 yrs | TUESDAY, THURSDAY | 9:00am-<br>11:15am | TEACHERS: Ashley, Christine and Krista |
| GROUP C:<br>2.5-4 yrs | TUESDAY, THURSDAY | 12:30pm-<br>3:00pm | TEACHERS: Ashley and Krista |
| GROUP D:<br>2.5- 4 yrs | MONDAY, WEDNESDAY | 12:30pm-<br>3:00pm | TEACHERS: Ashley and Krista |

Rockwood Nursery School will be closed during all statutory holidays, as well as during school closures set by the Upper Grand District School Board.

Class cancellations due to inclement weather will typically follow Upper Grand District School Board guidelines. As safety and quality care are a priority, the school reserves the right to close for other unforeseen circumstances when required**. A notice will be posted on our Facebook page by 7:30 a.m. if classes are cancelled. If a sudden need to cancel class arises, parents will be notified by phone.**

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## HOW TO REACH THE SCHOOL

**TELEPHONE NUMBER** 519-856-4486
**EMAIL r**ockwoodnurseryschool@gmail.com
**WEBSITE** www.rockwoodnurseryschool.ca

We keep parents informed about school news and upcoming events by emailing a monthly calendar and Teachers' Letter. School events will also be posted on our website and private Facebook page. The Parent Handbook, Policies and Procedures, and contact information are also available on our website. You will receive a password to access this information.

**This year's website password is: RNS2026**

## WHAT TO SEND TO SCHOOL

- Clean, non-slip indoor shoes.
- A change of clothing*.
- A back pack to carry crafts and belongings to and from school.
- Weather appropriate outdoor clothing and foot wear for community outings.
- If your child is in diapers, please provide: diapers, wipes and a changing pad.
- A nutritious, NUT-FREE snack and full water bottle**.
- Please be sure to label ALL of your child's belongings.

* Children will be encouraged to engage with crafts and activities that may include paints, water and other resources that could wet or soil their clothing. A change of clothes is helpful for when kids get extra messy/wet during play. We recommend only sending your child in clothes that you are comfortable getting messy.
**Parents are asked to send a healthy, allergen-free snack with *at least* two options of carbohydrates and fruit/vegetables, along with a filled water bottle. We ask that parents do not send juice or milk. Please use one container that is clearly marked with your child's name. **Parents must adhere to our *Anaphylaxis Policy.***

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## ADMISSION AND TUITION

**Admission:**
For your child to be enrolled in Rockwood Nursery School, their registration package must be fully completed and provided to the school's Registrar prior to your child's first day. If you child has special needs, an Individual Action Plan (IAP) is to be completed by parents/guardians prior to the child's first day.

**Tuition:**
Tuition is due on the first of each month and can be paid by post-dated cheque or e-transfer. Cash payments will not be accepted. Post-dated cheques are to be made payable to Rockwood Nursery School Inc. and provided to the Registrar at the time of registration**.** We do not allow for lump sum/full year payments. Children who are enrolled late (i.e. *after* the first week of the month or later) will be charged a reduced tuition amount for that month. Tuition will not be reduced if a child begins class late for personal reasons as per our Fees and Refund Policy (see page 15).

Rockwood Nursery School is enrolled in the Government funded Canada-Wide Early Learning Child Care program (CWELCC). As a result of this Government funding, our *base fee* is $12.00 per class until further notice.

**Late Payments:**
If tuition is not paid on the first of the month, or if a cheque is returned NSF, we will provide a two-week grace period for you to make the payment. If we have not received your payment by that time, your child may be unenrolled and their spot will be given to a student on the waiting list. For any cheque payments returned NSF, the school will apply an administration fee of $7.00 to the following month's tuition. This administration fee is a *non-base fee*. If for any reason you are having difficulty

with making your tuition payments, please contact our Tuition Manager. The teaching staff will provide you with their contact information.

**Withdrawal:**
If you wish to withdraw from Rockwood Nursery School prior to the end of June, you may do so at any time by giving the Registrar **2 weeks written notice**. With proper notice, partial tuition will be charged or refunded if your child is leaving the school prior to the month's end.

## FAMILY OUTINGS & WALKING TRIPS

To enhance your child's learning, our school participates in several family outings and excursions throughout the year. Details will be provided in the monthly Teacher Letter, on our website, and on Facebook. Parents are responsible for transporting their children to and from these outings. If a parent is unable to attend but wishes for their child to participate, they must arrange transportation and guardianship in advance.

Throughout the year, teachers may take children on walking trips to destinations within Rockwood (e.g., post office, conservation area, grocery store). Parents will be notified in advance. Please dress your child appropriately for the weather on these days.

## DROP OFF AND RELEASE OF CHILDREN

- The doors of the school will be opened **5 minutes** prior to class start time.
- Children must be picked up promptly at the end of their scheduled class time. If for any reason you will be late, please contact the school so that the teachers can make appropriate arrangements.
- No child will be released to anyone other than a parent/guardian, unless the teacher has received written direction and consent from the parent.
- For the safety of the children proof of ID may be requested at pick-up.

## CLEANING NIGHT

Each month, an evening is designated for the cleaning of the school's play areas and equipment. Each family will be assigned one cleaning night over the course of the school year. This schedule will be established at the beginning of the year and posted in the school entryway and on our website. If for some reason you cannot be present, you must make arrangements to switch your duty day with another parent. Please contact teachers with any changes that have been made.

## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Rockwood Nursery School knows the value of continuous professional development. Staff meet formally on a monthly basis as well as informally on a daily basis to review program plans and strategize for the future. Staff are encouraged to attend workshops and conferences by the County of Wellington. The staff networks with the other Co-operative preschools in the area quarterly

## INCLUSION SUPPORT SERVICES

Your childcare providers are experts in child development. They work with you to ensure your child is growing and learning alongside their peers. Sometimes, children require extra help with their development. Inclusion Support Services involve a collaborative group of professionals from various agencies who work together to support families and childcare programs.

The purpose of these services is to assist childcare providers by:

- Helping children reach their full potential.
- Ensuring all children are successfully included in the childcare program.

**Getting Support:**

If there are concerns about a child's development *before* they join the school, the Inclusion Coordinator from the County of Wellington Child Care Services can work with the family and program to support a smooth transition. At any time, childcare providers and parents can ask for assistance if they have concerns about a particular child's development. Providers can also seek advice when they want to better meet the needs of an entire group of children.

**Your Inclusion Team:**

Each childcare program has an **Inclusion Team**. The primary members are your childcare providers, who are experts in Early Childhood Education. The rest of the Team includes the following consultants:

- **An Occupational Therapist (OT)** from Kids Ability Center for Child Development to help children who have difficulties with daily routines, responding to sensory input, attention to tasks, feeding, hand play, or social skills.
- **A Physiotherapist (Physio)** from Kids Ability Center for Child Development to help children with balance, movement, and coordination.
- **A Speech and Language Pathologist (SLP)** from Wee Talk and Language services.
- **A Social Development Consultant.**

If you would like to meet the consultants assigned to your program, please ask your childcare providers to arrange an introduction. If you have any questions about these services, please speak with your childcare supervisor.

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## COMMUNICATION WITH THE SCHOOL

It is very important for parents to feel free to bring issues and concerns to the attention of the teachers and, if required, to the Board of Directors. At Rockwood Nursery School, the lines of communication are open, and we invite you to ask questions and share your ideas. While it is not the practice of Rockwood Nursery School to send home report cards, the teachers are observing and assessing your child on an ongoing basis. If you wish to arrange an interview to discuss developmental concerns, the teachers will be happy to oblige.

**Digital Communication:**

The school website, www.rockwoodnurseryschool.ca, is used to post all general communications, such as: class schedules, newsletters, events calendar, and the Parent Handbook. It is intended as a central point of reference for all parents in the school. Confidential information does not appear on the

website. The school also uses a private Facebook group to communicate school-wide messages to parents.

Please note: Signed permission from the parent or guardian is obtained by the school before a photograph of the child can appear on the website. The photo permission form is included in our registration package.

**Direct Communication:**
If our staff need to speak with you directly, they will contact you in person, over the phone, or by email. You are welcome to connect with staff during pick-up/drop-off, over the phone, or via email as well. If you need to speak with a Board Member, their names are listed below and are posted at the school. If you do not feel comfortable addressing the members in person, you may do so in writing. Their contact information can be provided upon request.

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## 2026/2027 BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Rockwood Nursery School's Board of Directors are the governing body responsible for the school's overall direction, financial health, and adherence to its mission. Directors are volunteers voted in by the school's general members (the parents) at the Annual General Meeting. This year's Board members are:

| | |
|---|---|
| **President…….** | **Taryn Lovell** |
| **Vice President…….** | **Jennifer Lunau** |
| **Secretary…….** | **Brittany MacPherson** |
| **Treasurer…….** | **Rebecca Stec** |
| **Liaison……** | **Jessica Anderson** |
| **Tuition Manager…..** | **Dani Hardy** |

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## ROCKWOOD NURSERY SCHOOL PROGRAM STATEMENT

**Reviewed July 2026**

The philosophy of Rockwood Nursery School reflects our belief that every child is a competent, curious, and capable individual who needs the opportunity to develop to their full potential in a warm, safe, and caring environment. Staff and parents work together to offer a stimulating space where each child can develop a sense of self-worth and pride. Everyone who comes to Rockwood Nursery School should feel that they belong, are engaged in the program, that their well-being is supported and enriched, and that they are free to express themselves.

At our school:

- Children will learn to trust the teacher, other adults, and other children.
- Teachers will be available, sensitive, responsive, and caring. This is the best way to build trust and help children feel safe and secure. These relationships support children in feeling free to discover, take risks, grow, and learn.
- Children will foster independence through their ability to choose activities.
- They will learn cooperation through sharing, waiting their turn, and being part of a group.
- They will learn to use materials properly and creatively.

- They will gain skills required to succeed in their future education.

We know that children learn best through play. Play provides the foundations for language, literacy, mathematics, science, technology, and creative arts. When children experience delight and success through these activities, they become motivated to continue learning. Children are naturally curious and explore their world through play. When we support this natural activity, their competence and capacity for learning are maximized.

The most important goal of our curriculum is to inspire joy, curiosity, and inquiry in the classroom. The children's wonder and excitement for learning will guide the teachers' priorities. We purposefully use an *Emergent Curriculum* approach, where curriculum is created day by day and week by week, with teachers making thoughtful plans based on the children's emerging interests and developmental needs. Our teachers use their knowledge of Early Childhood Development to observe the children and determine what developmental tasks they are working on. Based on these observations, teachers follow the children's explorations by providing collections of related materials that offer opportunities to make connections, create patterns, practice skills, and explore in their own way. Teachers enrich explorations by adding materials that introduce new ideas, challenges, and opportunities for problem-solving. They add meaning by documenting children's growth daily and posting documentation that highlights learning throughout the classroom.

**Emergent Curriculum includes environments suitable for a variety of play levels:**
Indoor and outdoor play activities, including community walks whenever possible

- Quiet and active play
- Group play as well as opportunities to play alone
- Routines, transitions, and schedules that provide space and time for children's choices

**Emergent Curriculum balances:**

- Spontaneity with planning
- Individual needs with the needs of the group
- Fun with learning
- Flexibility with goal-directed planning

Our daily and weekly planning is directly linked to the *Continuum of Development*. In our preschool programs, daily play highlights are documented and shared with parents. We use the *SeeSaw* app to share your child's day. Daily, teachers assess their program and environment to ensure it meets the needs of the children individually and as a group, and that the environment is responsive to children's interests. Weekly, the Supervisor and Teachers meet to review documentation and programming to ensure quality learning experiences.

**We understand the importance of the *Four Foundations of Learning*, and our programming reflects this. At Rockwood Nursery School, children learn best when they feel they belong. We support this by:**

- Welcoming each child and family at arrival.
- Responding positively and respectfully to children's ideas and contributions.
- Interacting with children at their level.
- Encouraging and supporting peer play to build social development.

- Knowing when to observe and when to support play.
- Modelling resilience and problem-solving skills
- Helping children identify their feelings and the feelings of others, and guiding them toward positive solutions.
- Providing an inclusive environment that celebrates each family's cultural beliefs.
- Celebrating holidays and customs, and offering materials, books, and toys that reflect the diversity of our community.
- Displaying family photos in the classroom and inviting families to share materials or customs.
- Asking parents to provide a family photo at the start of the year.

**A successful preschool program nurtures engagement for every child. To be truly engaged, a foundation of trust and respect must be established. We support this by:**

- Playing with the children, making eye contact, commenting, and asking questions during play.
- Playing alongside children to model social interactions, turn-taking, and language skills.
- Partnering with children in their learning by discovering their interests and strengths.
- Actively listening and giving children time and space to express themselves.
- Responding to challenging behaviours in positive and appropriate ways.
- Encouraging respect among children and modelling this ourselves.
- Talking about emotions and modelling empathy and self-regulation.

**Engagement with parents is equally important. We support this by:**

- Communicating daily at arrival and departure.
- Establishing trust through ongoing communication, including daily documentation on *SeeSaw.*
- Sharing information through emails, newsletters, and photo documentation.
- Offering an Orientation Night so parents can meet teachers and learn about the program.
- Creating a comfortable environment where families feel welcomed to stay and visit.
- Encouraging participation on our Board of Directors and committees.
- Planning special events and social activities for families throughout the year.

**We want children to feel safe, comfortable, and included. To support these values:**

- We maintain a flexible routine that balances free play with predictable structure.
- We observe children and provide toys and materials based on their interests.

**Rockwood Nursery School is committed to supporting the well-being of every child. We do this by:**

- Having parents provide nutritious snacks with at least two food options, as outlined in the Canada Food Guide. No foods containing nuts are allowed.
- Creating a family-like atmosphere at snack time.
- Ensuring all staff are trained to respond to emergencies.
- Encouraging physical activity.
- Providing opportunities for appropriate risk-taking.
- Completing daily health checks at arrival.
- Working with Wellington-Dufferin-Guelph Public Health to follow best practices.
- Requiring all staff/volunteers in ratio to have up-to-date First Aid and Infant/Child CPR.

- Requiring up-to-date immunization records for participating children, staff, and volunteers, or completed exemption forms.
- Informing parents of health-related exclusion guidelines.
- Ensuring every child with a life-threatening illness/allergy or medical condition has an Individual Action Plan.

**Child Guidance**
All Teachers, Parents, and Volunteers will follow our core values of caring, honesty, inclusiveness, respect, and responsibility. We ensure that every child feels a sense of belonging, self-worth, well-being, and engagement. We support children in developing strategies to remain calm, regulate emotions, and understand the impact of their behaviour on others.

**Prohibited Practices**
At Rockwood Nursery School, any practice based on negative control techniques is prohibited, including:

- Corporal punishment.
- Harsh or degrading measures that humiliate a child.
- Depriving a child of basic needs including food, shelter, clothing, or bedding.
- Locking exits or using locked spaces to confine a child.

Every staff member will be given a copy of the Prohibited Practices, required to read and sign off before working in the classroom. The Supervisor monitors and reviews staff/volunteer practices yearly.

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## SECTION 2: POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

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## PROGRAM STATEMENT IMPLEMENTATION POLICY

Date Reviewed: July 2026

**Purpose:**
The intent of the Program Statement Implementation Policy is to ensure that the Program Statement is consistently reviewed, monitored, and followed at Rockwood Nursery School. The Program Statement will be reviewed at each monthly meeting, providing staff with the opportunity to reflect and discuss any areas of concern.

- At Rockwood Nursery School, staff, students, volunteers, and families work together to offer a stimulating environment for children. We achieve this through open communication among all members of the school.
- All policies and procedures are accessible so that everyone is working from the same foundation.
- Teachers will reflect on and assess the program and environment daily to ensure that the program meets the individual needs of each child. Teachers will also meet weekly to review and document program plans to ensure high-quality programming.

- We strive to provide an inclusive environment by celebrating the diverse cultural beliefs of families. We recognize different holidays and customs and provide materials, books, puzzles, and toys that reflect the lives of our school community.
- Children need to feel engaged and able to trust the staff and their surroundings. To support this, teachers will interact with children at their level—making eye contact, asking questions, and valuing each child as an individual.
- Engagement with parents is equally important. We foster this through ongoing communication and building meaningful relationships with families. We share information through emails, newsletters, and documentation, and we welcome parents to participate in the school by sharing special talents, hobbies, or interests.
- Teachers, volunteers, and students are required to read and sign that they understand the Behaviour Management Policy. Compliance is monitored and documented monthly.
- Nutrition is essential to growing children. Parents are asked to provide a healthy snack for their child.
- At Rockwood Nursery School, we strive to maintain a safe and healthy environment for everyone. Staff must hold up-to-date First Aid/Infant and Child CPR certification.
- Everyone involved in the program must provide an up-to-date immunization record.
- Every child with a life-threatening allergy or medical condition must have an Individual Action Plan, signed by all staff and volunteers working with that child.

**Philosophy of Inclusion:**

Inclusion at Rockwood Nursery School means that staff work to support the participation of all children, regardless of ability. Children with special needs—whether physical, medical, or cognitive—and their parents are welcome and encouraged to be involved in the program.

A strong partnership between parents/caregivers and staff is essential in creating the best possible environment for each child. Parents are encouraged to participate in developing any required support services or developmental/behavioural goals, in consultation with regional staff (e.g., inclusion consultants, child care services consultants, and other professionals).

Supports, services, and goals are identified through the development and annual review of a child's Individual Support Plan (ISP). To ensure safety and optimal development, an Inclusion Support staff member may be required to assist within the program.

**Safe and Healthy Environment:**

At Rockwood Nursery School, we are committed to ensuring a safe and healthy environment for all children, staff, parents, and volunteers.

- Every staff member and any volunteer counted in ratio must hold up-to-date First Aid and Infant/Child CPR certification.
- Children, staff, parents, and volunteers involved in the program must provide an up-to-date immunization record at the time of enrollment, or provide a completed Statement of Medical Exemption(signed by a Doctor or NP) or a notarized Statement of Conscience or Religious Belief.
- Parents are informed of illness guidelines that outline when a child may not attend the preschool program.

- Every child with a life-threatening illness, allergy, or other medical/physical condition must have an Individual Action Plan completed by the parents. This plan outlines the condition, signs and symptoms to watch for, and the necessary steps to respond.
- Every staff member, resource personnel, parent, and volunteer interacting with the children will read, understand, and sign the Individual Action Plan. The plan will be posted in the snack area and in the kitchen.

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## SAFE ARRIVAL AND DISMISSAL POLICY

**Policy Established: November 30 2023**
**Policy Reviewed : June 2026**

**Purpose:**
This policy and its procedures support the safe arrival and dismissal of children receiving care. It provides staff, students, and volunteers with a clear understanding of their roles and responsibilities for ensuring children's safety during arrival and dismissal. This includes the steps to take when a child does not arrive at the school as expected and the procedures for safe dismissal.This policy fulfills the requirements under **Ontario Regulation 137/15** for safe arrival and dismissal procedures.

**Policy:**
- Rockwood Nursery School will ensure that any child receiving care is released **only** to the child's parent/guardian or to an individual for whom the parent/guardian has provided written authorization. This includes individuals listed in the registration package.
- Where a child does not arrive as expected, or is not picked up as expected, staff must follow the procedures outlined below.

**Procedures:**
**1. Accepting a Child into Care**
When accepting a child into care at drop-off, the program staff in the room must:
- Greet the parent/guardian.
- Ask how the child's evening/morning has been and whether there are any changes to the child's pick-up arrangements.
  - If someone other than the parent/guardian will be picking up the child, staff must confirm that the person is listed in the child's registration package.
  - If the individual is **not** listed, staff must request written authorization from the parent/guardian (email or written note).
- Any changes in pick-up procedure are to me documented in the daily log book.
- Sign the child in on the attendance record.

**2. If a child has not arrived and the parent/guardian has not communicated an absence:**
- Staff must inform other staff members present and begin contacting the parent/guardian by **9:30 a.m. (morning program)** or **1:00 p.m. (afternoon program)**.
- Staff must attempt to contact the parent/guardian by phone. If they cannot be reached, staff will contact the emergency contacts listed in the registration package.
- Staff will continue attempts for **30 minutes** after the initial call.

- If after 30 minutes, no parent/guardian or emergency contact can be reached, staff will notify police using the non-emergency number: **1-888-310-1122** or **519-856-1506**.

**3. Confirmed Absence:**
Once a child's absence has been confirmed, program staff must document the absence and any additional relevant information in the daily attendance log.

**4. Releasing a Child from Care:**
The supervising staff member at pickup must release a child only to:

- The child's parent/guardian, **or**
- An authorized individual for whom written permission has been provided.

**If staff do not recognize the individual picking up:**

- Confirm with another staff member that the person is authorized, **or**
- Request photo identification and verify it against the names listed in the child's file or the written authorization.

**5. When a Child Has Not Been Picked Up at Closing Time:**

- A **10-minute grace period** will be given.
- After the grace period, staff will call the parent/guardian.
- If unable to reach the parent/guardian, staff will:
    - Leave a voicemail, and
    - Attempt to contact the authorized pick-up person, if applicable.
- If staff still have not heard back, they will phone the emergency contacts.
- If no one can be reached, staff must follow the procedures below ("Where a child has not been picked up and the centre is closed").

**6. When a Child Has Not Been Picked Up and the Centre Is Closed**

- If a parent/guardian or authorized pick-up person has not arrived after **60 minutes**, staff will ensure the child is provided with a snack and activity while waiting.
- If no parent/guardian, authorized pick-up person, or emergency contact has been reached **within 2 hours of closing**, staff will contact the **Children's Aid Society (CAS)** and follow CAS direction.

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## VULNERABLE SECTOR POLICE CHECK POLICY

**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

A clear Vulnerable Sector Check is required for all employees, volunteers, and students before they begin their employment, volunteering, or interaction with the children in the centre. This check must be requested through the police service in the applicant's place of residence. Obtaining a Vulnerable Sector Check is a precautionary measure used to help determine whether individuals involved in the provision of child care are fit and suitable to hold positions of trust. Considering a person's relevant criminal history helps ensure the safety and well-being of children in care.

If a person's relationship with the school is terminated for longer than six months, a new Vulnerable Sector Check is required. The original cleared check must be provided to the centre, and the Supervisor will sign a declaration confirming that he or she has seen the original document.

Vulnerable Sector Checks must be renewed on or before every fifth anniversary of the most recent check. In the interim calendar years, each person who has provided a check must complete an Offence Declaration (current to within 15 days of the anniversary date of the previous check or declaration and addressing the period since that most recent check or declaration). Any person required to provide a Vulnerable Sector Check to Rockwood Nursery School must provide the centre with an Offence Declaration as soon as reasonably possible if he or she is convicted of an offence under the Criminal Code of Canada.

Rockwood Nursery School reserves the right to terminate its relationship with any individual based on the nature of a conviction. The Supervisor and President will be responsible for reviewing any convictions and determining whether the individual may continue in their role with the school. All police checks, declarations, and related information will be kept confidential between the individual, the Supervisor, and the President.

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## SUPERVISON OF VOLUNTEERS AND STUDENTS POLICY

**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Policy Overview:**

- Volunteers or students are not permitted to be alone with a child at any time without the direct supervision of a Rockwood Nursery School staff member.
- Volunteers and students will not be counted in staffing ratios at any time.
- Before a volunteer or student begins working in the school, the Supervisor will review all school policies and the individual Anaphylactic Plan for each child with an anaphylactic allergy.
- Each volunteer or student will sign and date a declaration stating that they have read and understand each policy. This review will be completed annually and kept in the child's file.
- All volunteers and students are required to provide a Criminal Reference Check before commencing work at the school.

**Supervisor's Responsibilities:**

- Ensure that each student or volunteer (other than participating parents who act as staff members) is properly supervised by a qualified staff member at all times.
- Ensure students or volunteers are never alone with children.
- Review the school's Behaviour Management Policy, Emergency Procedures, and the Individual Anaphylactic Plan for each child with an anaphylactic allergy with the student or volunteer before they begin working in the school, and obtain their signature and date confirming it has been read.
- Review the above-noted policies and procedures annually with each student or volunteer, and sign and date each annual review.

**Volunteer and Student Responsibilities:**

- Be positive with staff, parents, and children.
- Be attentive to the entire room.
- Participate actively—engage with the children at their level, including play on the floor, and assist with activities and crafts.
- Be aware of children's needs, such as helping to tie shoes and wash hands.
- Encourage kindness, sharing, and independence.
- Help teach classroom rules, including: using walking feet, tidying up one activity before starting the next, and treating toys and equipment with respect.
- Model all of the above behaviours.

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## FEES AND REFUNDS POLICY

Date Established: September 2026

**Fees:**

Rockwood Nursery School will apply *base-fee* amounts (i.e. tuition) in compliance with guidance from the CWELCC (Canada-Wide Early Learning and Child Care) program and CCEYA (Child Care and Early Years Act). Rockwood Nursery school will provide an overview of *non-base fees* to parents. The fees will be voluntary and have no impact on access to care (i.e NSF administration fees).

**Refunds:**

Refunds to parents will be provided under the following circumstances:

1. Fees refunded for Early Years Professional Development Days.
2. Oversight in payment.

**Policy Overview:**

- No registration or waitlist fees will be charged in accordance with the CWELCC (Canada-Wide Early Learning and Child Care) and CCEYA (Child Care and Early Years Act) guidelines.
- The preschool is currently enrolled in the CWELCC program. The preschool will raise or freeze fees in accordance with program requirements and regulations.
- Fees shall not be increased within a current school year. If fees must be adjusted for the operation of the preschool, such changes will be determined by the Board of Directors and ratified by the membership at the Annual General Meeting for implementation in the following school year.
- Refunds will not be made when the school is temporarily closed for unprecedented/emergency reasons including but not limited to: declared state of emergency, public health directives for communicable disease outbreak, inclement weather, power outage, fire or flooding.
- Refunds will not be made when a child is absent due to illness or other personal reasons.

## WAIT LIST POLICY

**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Purpose:**
The intent of this policy is to prohibit Rockwood Nursery School from charging parents a fee for placing their child on a wait list for an unsecured spot in the school. The policy also ensures that wait lists are accessible to prospective parents while maintaining the privacy and confidentiality of all children listed.

**Procedures:**
The wait list will be organized according to each class. As spaces become available in a particular class, the first child on the corresponding list will be contacted. The parent/guardian will have **48 hours** to decide whether they will accept or decline the spot. If the offer is declined or no response is received within 48 hours, the space will be offered to the next family on the list.

Parents/guardians may contact the Registrar at any time to inquire about their child's position on the waiting list. The Registrar will provide this information without disclosing any details about other families or children. A child's name will remain on the current year's waiting list until **June 2027**, when the school closes for the summer, at which point the new waiting list for the upcoming year will come into effect. Registration for the upcoming year takes place in **February & March 2027**. If necessary, a new waiting list for the upcoming year will be created at that time.

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## HEALTH AND SAFETY POLICY

**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Purpose:**
The purpose of this policy is to ensure a safe and healthy environment for all staff, parents, volunteers, and children. It aims to:

- Foster awareness of common and significant infectious diseases within the school community.
- Provide guidance for preventing and managing infectious diseases.
- Educate families and staff that good hygiene is essential in limiting the spread of infection.

**Health Records and Immunization Requirements:**
The *Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014* requires children attending licensed child care in Ontario to have an up-to-date immunization record, as recommended by the local Medical Officer of Health. A complete history of a child's immunization must be provided to Public Health in order to attend Rockwood Nursery School. A photocopy of the child's health records (from birth onward) must be submitted with registration. Parents/guardians are responsible for maintaining and updating their child's immunization record and notifying Rockwood Nursery School when new immunizations are completed. The school will keep this record on file.

Immunizations are not mandatory in Ontario; however, **if families choose not to immunize, the following steps must be taken:**

- File a legal exemption, notarized and signed by a Commissioner of Oaths.
- Provide copies of the exemption to the school, which will forward them to Public Health.

If a staff member, volunteer, or child is not immunized, they may be excluded from the school during an outbreak until Public Health advises it is safe to return.

Parents of a child with special health needs (e.g., life-threatening allergies) must inform staff and complete the appropriate Individual Action Plan outlining the child's emergency procedures.

Parents must not send their child to school if the child is unwell—especially if they have had a fever, vomited, or experienced diarrhea within the past 24 hours. Children must also remain home if they display symptoms of a contagious disease, such as a rash, until assessed and cleared by a health care professional.

**No Child Will Be Admitted to School If They Show Signs of the Following:**

- Acute cold or excessive coughing.
- Vomiting or diarrhea.
- Red, scratchy, or discharging eyes or ears (until conjunctivitis or eye infection is ruled out).
- Undiagnosed skin rashes or infections (mild rashes without fever or behaviour changes may not require exclusion).
- Fever within the last 24 hours.
- Starting a prescribed antibiotic within the last 48 hours (e.g., pink eye, chest infection, strep throat).
- Continuous dry, hacking cough.
- Contact with or quarantine for a serious respiratory illness within the household (e.g., SARS, COVID-19).
- Head lice (child must be treated with medicated shampoo and combed thoroughly before returning).
- General signs of illness such as unusual fatigue, irritability, or loss of appetite.

Children must be symptom-free for at least **24 hours** before returning to school. If prescribed medication, they must remain home for at least **48 hours** after the first dose.

Communicable diseases (e.g., measles, impetigo, rubella, scabies, pertussis, mumps, conjunctivitis, strep throat, chicken pox, or prolonged illness) must be reported to staff as soon as possible.

Parents must notify the school of absences due to illness or other reasons by calling **519-856-4486** and providing the child's name and reason for absence.

**Care of Mildly Ill or Minorly Injured Children:**

If a child becomes ill or sustains a minor injury while at school, staff will contact the parent/guardian or emergency contacts immediately. Parents must arrange prompt pickup. While waiting:

- The child will be separated from the group in a nurturing and supervised manner.
- A quiet space for rest will be provided if needed.
- Any resting items (blanket, toy) will be sanitized after use.
- Staff will take the child's temperature when symptoms include nausea, vomiting, flushed cheeks, diarrhea, excessive coughing, or fatigue.

- In cases of fever, staff may sponge the child with tepid water.
- Staff will wear disposable gloves when handling body fluids or waste.
- Soiled clothing will be bagged in double plastic bags and sent home.

Serious injuries will follow the **Serious Occurrence Policy**. Medication administration must follow the **Medication Administration Policy**. In the event of a pandemic or public health emergency, the school will follow Public Health directives.

**First Aid Training:**
All teaching staff must hold valid **Standard First Aid and CPR-C** certification.

The school will ensure:
- A working telephone is available.
- Emergency numbers are posted beside the phone.
- The emergency contact binder is easily accessible and is taken during evacuations.
- Fire procedures are followed during evacuations.
- Monthly fire drills are conducted and recorded.
- Staff, parents, and volunteers are instructed in evacuation procedures before beginning in the classroom.
- Power outlets are covered.
- Kitchen and storage room doors remain closed at all times.

The Nursery School will maintain 2 First Aid kits:
1. One in the main classroom.
2. One in the excursion backpack.

**Health & Safety Practices:**
Rockwood Nursery School is committed to maintaining a safe and healthy environment, therefore:
- All staff/volunteers counted in ratio must maintain current First Aid and CPR-C certification.
- All individuals participating in the program (children, staff, parents, volunteers) must provide up-to-date immunization records at enrollment.
- Parents are provided with information about illnesses that prevent a child from attending school.
- Each child with a life-threatening illness/allergy must have an Individual Action Plan completed by parents. All staff, resource personnel, parents, and volunteers working with the child must read and sign off on the Action Plan. The Action Plan will be posted at the snack area and in the kitchen.

**Sanitation Procedures:**
- Children, staff, and volunteers must wash hands after toileting, after crafts, and before and after meals/snacks.
- Toilets and sinks are cleaned and sanitized daily.
- All dishes and utensils are washed according to Wellington-Dufferin-Guelph Public Health standards.
- Snack tables are sanitized before and after snack time.
- Carpets are vacuumed after each class.

- Soiled items (smocks, towels, dishcloths) are stored separately and laundered at least weekly.
- Thorough cleaning of equipment, furnishings, and carpets is completed before school year begins and monthly during the school year.
- Dress-up clothing, blankets, and similar items are washed as needed and at least once a month.

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## CHILD WITH MEDICAL NEEDS POLICY

**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Purpose**

Rockwood Nursery School is committed to taking all necessary steps to support a child's medical needs and ensure their full inclusion in the program. To do this, the school will develop an *Individualized Plan for a Child with Medical Needs (IPCMN*) for any child requiring medical accommodations. At enrollment, parents/guardians must complete an *Individualized Plan for a Child with Medical Needs Form* before their child's first day of school.

**An IPCMN form will include:**

- An overview of the child's medical needs.
- Steps to reduce the risk of the child being exposed to any causative agents or situations that may trigger or worsen a medical condition or cause a medical emergency.
- A description of any medical devices used by the child and instructions for their use.
- Procedures to follow in the event of a medical emergency.
- A description of the supports available to the child within the childcare setting.
- Any additional procedures required when the child is evacuating the building or participating in a field trip.

**Staff Responsibilities and Review Requirements:**

Upon receiving the IPCMN, Rockwood Nursery School will ensure:

- All staff have reviewed the plan.
- All staff have signed off to indicate understanding of the child's needs and procedures.

This process ensures that every staff member and volunteer has the necessary information to appropriately respond to any medical situation involving the child. Each IPCMN will be reviewed **annually**, unless changes occur during the school year. If a child's medical needs change:

- Parents/guardians must update the plan.
- Staff must review and sign off on the revised plan.

**Relation to Anaphylaxis Policy:**

If a child already has an *Individualized Plan and Emergency Procedures for a Child with an Anaphylactic Allergy* on file, an IPCMN is *not* required. In these cases, Rockwood Nursery School will follow the *Anaphylaxis Policy.*

# ANAPHYLAXIS POLICY

**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Purpose:**

Rockwood Nursery School is committed to providing a safe and inclusive environment for all children, including those at risk of anaphylaxis. This policy outlines procedures for prevention, recognition, and emergency response to anaphylactic reactions, and ensures all staff, students, and volunteers understand their responsibilities. Enrollment of a child with anaphylaxis is considered a special need. This policy provides consistent guidelines for communication, training, documentation, and emergency preparedness.

**Definition of Anaphylaxis:**

Anaphylaxis is a severe, potentially life-threatening allergic reaction that can occur within minutes of exposure to an allergen. Common allergens include various foods, insect stings, medications, and latex. Epinephrine (adrenaline), delivered through an auto-injector into the muscle of the outer side of the thigh is the recommended treatment. Signs and symptoms of anaphylaxis symptoms can come on slowly or rapidly, change quickly and vary. Common symptoms may include:

- Skin reactions (hives, swelling).
- Respiratory symptoms (wheezing, cough, rapid shallow breathing, acute runny eyes and nose, throat tightness, or closure of airway).
- Gastrointestinal symptoms (nausea/ vomiting, cramps, diarrhea).
- Cardiovascular symptoms (paleness, blue colouring, weak pulse, dizziness).
- Neurological symptoms (headache, seizures, anxiety).
- Shock, loss of consciousness and death.

**Identification of Children at Risk:**

At registration, parents/guardians must disclose any known severe allergies and required emergency medications. Upon enrolling a child with anaphylaxis, parents are to complete an *Individualized Plan and Emergency Procedures for a Child with an Anaphylactic Allergy Form*( IPEPCAA) before the child begins attending the school. The IPECAA will outline the following:

- The child's name, DOB, photo if possible.
- The nature of the allergy and a description of the allergic reaction.
- Monitoring and avoidance strategies in addition to the risk-reduction measures already held by the school (see below).
- The expected action to be taken by staff in the event of an anaphylactic reaction, including details about where the medication will be located, how it is administered, which staff is expected to administer it, and the medication's expiration date.
- Parental/Guardian consent for staff to administer medication.
- Contact information for parents/ guardians and emergency contacts.

The locations of the IPECAA will be known to all staff and reviewed monthly. In addition to staff being trained in allergic reaction emergency response as part of their regular First Aid and CPR-C certification, parents will also be asked to educate the teachers about the administration of epinephrine or other required medications, such as inhalers, for their children. Parents will provide required medication with

clear labels that indicate the child's name and dosage. The child's epinephrine auto-injector will be worn in a pouch by the teacher whenever the child is present.

In addition to having IPECAAs posted and accessible, an *Allergy Chart* will also be posted in the kitchen, and at the snack area that will summarize identified children and any known allergies. To restrict the entry of allergens into the school, an *Allergy Alert* sign, which lists all the known life-threatening allergies had by staff and/or students at the school, will be posted at the entrance of the school, in the snack area, and in the kitchen.

**Prevention and Risk-Reduction Measures:**

Rockwood Nursery School is a **nut-free facility and forbids the entry of nuts including tree nuts.** In the event that a child has food allergies other than or in addition to nuts, it is expected that all parents comply with additional allergen precautions. To ensure rigorous prevention, Rockwood Nursery School will:

- Ensure IPECAAs are up to date, in the child's file, posted in the kitchen, and posted near the eating area.
- Refuse and remove any item that enters the school which is suspected of containing or having contacted a known allergen.
- Forbid food sharing.
- Ensure snacks are eaten on plates/ napkins /directly out of containers to create barriers to prevent cross contact with allergens.
- Guarantee that all materials used in classrooms for activities are allergen-free.
- Encourage and model proper handwashing and sanitation measures, including immediately before and following eating.
- Ensure that First Aid and CPR-C certification is complete and up to date for all staff and volunteers.
- Staff will educate and support all children in understanding allergies and symptoms in an age-appropriate way to encourage self-care and care for others.

**Emergency Response Procedure:**

1. If anaphylaxis is suspected in a child that is known to have an allergy:
    - Follow the child's IPECAA.
    - Administer epinephrine immediately, and call 911.
    - Continue first aid measures until help arrives.
    - Notify parents.

2. If an allergic reaction is suspected in a child with no known allergies or IPECAA:
    - Provide emergency first aid and call 911.
    - Continue first aid measures until help arrives.
    - Notify parents.

3. If a child has been exposed to a known allergen, but shows no signs of reaction:
    - Children are to be monitored closely for symptoms.

- Parents/ Guardians are to be contacted immediately to pick up the child.
- The child is to be taken to seek medical assessment by their parent/guardian.

**Post-Incident Review:**
Once the emergency situation has resolved, staff will complete required documentation and notify the Board of Directors and relevant authorities (see *Serious Occurrence Policy*). As per the Serious Occurrence Policy, staff will complete an Incident Report to be signed by parents and kept in the child's file. Staff will then debrief, review the child's IPECAA and review all other policies and procedures to determine if improvements can be made.

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## BEHAVIOR MANAGEMENT POLICY

**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Purpose:**
Rockwood Nursery School is committed to fostering a positive learning environment in all aspects of child care, including during challenging situations that require child guidance. Corporal punishment and other prohibited disciplinary practices are strictly forbidden to protect the emotional and physical well-being of children. Our positive discipline program ensures health, safety, and respect for the rights of others. We believe that children have the right to quality child care that is safe, healthy, and provides learning opportunities promoting their growth and development.

To ensure a child's safety and well-being and to support social and emotional development, it is sometimes necessary to establish limits and standards for acceptable behavior. Teachers are guided by their knowledge of child development and the individual needs of each child. Effective guidance occurs within a trusting and caring relationship between teacher and child, achieved through genuine interest, warmth, and respect for the child and their feelings. Staff support each child's sense of self-worth while providing opportunities to learn appropriate ways to interact with others. Promoting self-esteem helps children become emotionally healthy and confident. Once trust and security are established, children feel safe to express themselves, knowing that supportive and understanding adults are available to help them navigate challenges.

Child guidance is maintained through careful supervision, clear limits, and age-appropriate explanations. Teachers approach discipline positively, using praise and attention to encourage desirable behaviors. Each child is treated as a unique individual, with fairness and consistency. Children are encouraged to accept the consequences of their behavior and engage in problem-solving when age-appropriate.

**Positive Discipline Methods:**
Discipline at Rockwood Nursery School fosters cooperation and independence through positive reinforcement and redirection (guiding a child to another activity). Consistency and clear limits promote self-discipline. Disciplinary measures are developmentally appropriate, timely, and focused on behavior rather than the child. Examples of positive discipline methods include:

1. **Redirection:** Guiding a child toward an acceptable alternative.
2. **Natural and Logical Consequences:** Helping children understand the results of their actions.
3. **Setting Limits:** Establishing boundaries for individuals or groups as needed.
4. **Modeling:** Demonstrating appropriate behaviors.

5. **Providing Choices:** Presenting children with options and encouraging decision-making.
6. **Anticipating:** Planning and preparing the environment to prevent conflicts.

**Behavior Management Policy Adherence:**
All staff, supply staff, volunteers, and duty parents are required, upon employment or prior to participating in school programs and annually thereafter, to sign a form confirming that they have read and understood this policy. Records are retained for two years. Failure to comply with this policy will result in immediate action by the Board of Directors. As operators of Rockwood Nursery School, the Board is forbidden from allowing any practice defined as a prohibited disciplinary practice under the *Child Care and Early Years Act (2014*). The Board is responsible for reviewing, monitoring, and maintaining all records pertaining to the Behavior Management Policy.

**Prohibited Disciplinary Practices:**
The following are strictly prohibited:

- Corporal punishment.
- Physical restraint used as punishment or in lieu of supervision, except to prevent imminent harm.
- Locking exits to confine a child without adult supervision, except during emergencies as per licensed emergency management policies.
- Harsh, degrading measures, threats, or derogatory language that may humiliate, shame, frighten, or undermine a child's self-respect or dignity.
- Deprivation of basic needs (i.e. food, drink, shelter, sleep, toilet use, clothing, or bedding) or infliction of bodily harm, including forcing children to eat or drink against their will.

**Non-Compliance Procedures:**

- **Staff/Supply Staff:**
    1. Verbal warning
    2. Written warning
    3. Dismissal
- **Program Volunteers:**
    1. Verbal warning
    2. Written warning
    3. Formal notice prohibiting participation in school events involving children
- **Reporting Board Non-Compliance:**
  Staff or volunteers may:
    1. Formally notify the Board
    2. Request a meeting with the Board
    3. Request a General Meeting if unresolved
    4. Inform the Program Advisor of the Ministry of Education (Child Care) by letter

**Monitoring:**

- The Board will review this policy with board members and program volunteers.
- The Supervisor will ensure that staff, supply staff, and volunteers review permitted disciplinary practices upon employment and annually, and receive professional development if needed.
- Parents are informed via the *Parent Handbook* that Rockwood Nursery School's approach is based on positive reinforcement and redirection.

- Any behavior causing harm is addressed according to the *Health and Safety Policy* or *Serious Occurrence Policy*, and parents/guardians are notified.

**Informing Parents:**

- Persistent disruptive behavior is brought to the attention of the Board by the Supervisor.
- Staff will discuss any negative behavior with parents to determine patterns and develop positive, supportive solutions.
- Staff may provide information on local professional resources if required.
- If a child poses a danger to themselves or others, they may be asked to leave the school.

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## SERIOUS OCCURRENCE POLICY

**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Purpose:**

This policy ensures that Rockwood Nursery School has a clear plan to manage serious incidents affecting the health, safety, or well-being of children and staff. All Serious Occurrences are reported, tracked, and followed up according to regulatory requirements.

**Categories of Serious Occurrence:**

- Death of a child
- Allegation of abuse and/or neglect of a child while in care at Rockwood Nursery School
- Life-threatening injury or illness
- Missing or unsupervised children:
  a) The child was found
  b) The child is still missing
- Unplanned disruption of normal operations, including:
  a) Fire
  b) Flood
  c) Gas leak
  d) Carbon monoxide
  e) Outbreak
  f) Lockdown
  g) Other emergency relocation or temporary closure

**Procedure Specific to Missing Child:**

If a child is missing from any program at Rockwood Nursery School, staff will follow this emergency procedure:

1. Immediately alert **all staff** upon realizing a child is missing.
2. The **Supervisor** will search all areas of the school while the teacher remains with other children.
3. If the child cannot be located within the school, the Supervisor will notify the parents/guardians in case they have information about the child's whereabouts.
4. If the child remains missing, the Supervisor will contact the police immediately.

**Informing the Supervisor:**

- The Supervisor must be notified immediately of all injuries to children and staff.

- If the Supervisor is unavailable, the **Acting Supervisor** and the **President of the Board of Directors** will be informed.
- In the case of a missing child, the Supervisor or Acting Supervisor is informed after the steps outlined in the "Procedure Specific to Missing Child" section are followed.

**Determining Action:**

- If immediate medical aid is required, the Supervisor will call **911** and provide details of the emergency. Emergency personnel will determine the appropriate response. The Supervisor will then contact the child's parents/guardians.
- A list of emergency contact numbers is kept by the phone and accessible to all staff.
- A staff member will remain with the child at all times, providing first aid.
- If a child requires hospital transport via ambulance, a staff member must accompany the child, taking the child's file if a parent/guardian has not arrived.
- Minor injuries not requiring emergency response are addressed according to the Health and Safety Policy.

**Reporting:**

- Following any incident requiring hospital care, the staff member involved will complete an **Incident/Accident/Injury Report**.
- Parents/Guardians will be informed and required to sign the report, which will be filed in the child's record.
- For Serious Occurrences, the Supervisor must complete the **Serious Occurrence Report Form** and post it on the Parent Board.
- The Supervisor or President must submit the **Serious Occurrence Initial Report (INR)** online through the **Child Care Licensing System (CCLS)** within **24 hours** of awareness.
    - Identify children only by initials and other individuals by non-identifying terms (e.g., Staff A, Staff B).
    - Use the organization name as it appears on the license or legal name of the service provider.
- Complete and post the **Serious Occurrence Notification Form** in a visible location for parents for **10 days** from the date of the final update.
- If CCLS is inaccessible, notify the program advisor by phone or email and submit the report once the system is available.
- Within **seven business days** of the INR submission, staff must submit the **Serious Occurrence Inquiry Report (IR)** online through CCLS, even if some actions remain incomplete, noting that a follow-up report will be provided.
- The Ministry of Education may request additional information or initiate a review. Service providers may submit a completed IR in place of an INR if all necessary actions are documented within 24 hours.
- The **County of Wellington** must be advised within 24 hours of reporting a Serious Occurrence.
- The Nursery School will retain the Serious Occurrence Notification Form on file for **three years**.

# MEDICATION ADMINISTRATION POLICY

Date Reviewed: July 2026

**Purpose:**
The purpose of this policy is to provide clear guidelines for the safe storage and administration of medication at Rockwood Nursery School. Whenever possible, parents should administer medication before bringing their child to school. If the school must administer medication, the following guidelines apply.

**Responsibilities:**

- The **Supervisor** or **Teacher in Charge** is responsible for all medications.
- Medication must be handed directly to the Supervisor.
- All medications must be stored and administered according to the label instructions and only with **written authorization** from the child's parent/guardian.
- Medications are stored in a locked container, except for **anaphylactic medications**, which are worn by the teacher in a fanny pack.
- Medications must be administered **only from the original container** supplied by a pharmacist, clearly labeled with:
    - Child's name
    - Name of medication
    - Dosage
    - Instructions for storage and administration
- Parents are responsible for giving medication to the teacher and retrieving any unused medication.

**Parental Consent:**
A signed *Consent Form for the Administration of Prescribed and Non-Prescribed Medications* must include:

- Child's name and medication name
- Dosage
- Start and stop dates
- Time interval for administration
- Permission to contact the dispensing pharmacist
- Pharmacist's name and phone number
- Physician's name and phone number
- Special instructions
- Reactions that require stopping the medication
- Potential side effects

**Documentation:**

- All medication administration must be recorded on the *Administration of Prescribed and Non-Prescribed Medication Chart*, including:
    - Child's name
    - Date
    - Medication and dosage given
    - Time administered
    - Name/initials of staff administering

- Leftover medication must be returned to parents.
- In the event of an incorrect administration, the parent/guardian and physician will be notified immediately.

**Medication Administration Procedures:**
Medications will be administered in a **quiet area away from activity areas**. Staff must follow these steps:

1. Check the chart to ensure the medication has not already been given.
2. Wash hands thoroughly.
3. Prepare supplies: medication, measuring equipment, drink for the child, and tissues for cleanup if needed.
4. For liquid medication, use a proper measuring spoon, syringe, dropper, or cup provided by parents.
5. Read the medication label carefully.
6. Check the **five rights** before administration:
    1. Right medication
    2. Right child
    3. Right dose
    4. Right time
    5. Right route (oral, injection, etc.)
7. Check the expiry date.
8. Compare the medication label with the information on the administration chart.
9. Read the label three times:
    a) When removing the medication from storage
    b) Before pouring or preparing the dose
    c) After returning the container to storage
10. Return the medication container to storage and wash hands.
11. Administer the medication to the child.
12. Record administration on the chart with date, time, and initials.
13. Clean and sanitize all equipment used (spoon, syringe, cup) and allow to air dry. Wash hands thoroughly.

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## EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT POLICY AND PROCEDURES

**Date Established: July 2017**
**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Purpose:**
The purpose of this policy is to ensure the safety of children and adults at Rockwood Nursery School in the event of an emergency. It provides clear direction to staff on the protocols to follow, ensuring that children are kept safe, accounted for, and supervised at all times during an emergency situation.

**Procedures:**
In the event that an emergency requires evacuation of the school, the following procedures must be followed:

1. The Supervisor will retrieve the yellow rope (kept in the plastic storage unit by the music center), blow the whistle to signal an emergency, and indicate that the school must be evacuated. Staff, children, and volunteers are trained in this procedure as part of monthly fire drills (see Fire Drill and Evacuation Policy).
2. All children will be directed by staff and volunteers to hold onto the rope.
3. The teacher will ensure all children are out of the bathrooms and will take the emergency binder from the shelf, then take the end of the rope.
4. Children will be led outside by all teachers and volunteers. The Supervisor will take attendance to ensure that all children and adults are accounted for.
5. Any children with an Individualized Action Plan will have their specific procedures followed.
6. Once outside the building, the Supervisor or teacher will call 911 to engage the appropriate emergency services.
7. If it is unsafe to return to the school, children and volunteers will be led to the Eramosa Café, located at 185 Main St. South, Rockwood, ON.
8. If the emergency results in a serious occurrence, the procedures outlined in the Serious Occurrence Policy will be followed.

In the event that an emergency makes it unsafe to leave the school, teachers and students will shelter in place, away from doors and windows:

1. The supervisor will call 911 to engage with appropriate emergency services.
2. The teacher will then work to contact parents to inform them of the situation and advise next steps (i.e for parents to also take shelter and await permission to come to the school from authorities).

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## FIREDRILL AND EVACUATION POLICY

**Date Reviewed: June 2026**

**Purpose:**

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that all staff, children, and volunteers are familiar with evacuation procedures in the event of fire or another emergency. Regular drills are conducted to reinforce these procedures, ensuring that everyone feels confident in following them.

**Staff Training and Responsibilities:**

- Before commencing employment, all staff members will be instructed on their responsibilities during a fire or other emergency.
- Staff must sign off acknowledging their understanding of these procedures and review them annually each September before school begins.

**Posting of Procedures:**

- The **Fire Procedure** will be posted in the Main Room and on the Teachers' Board, visible at all times.
- An additional copy will be posted in the Kitchen area.

**Fire Drills:**

- Fire drills will be conducted monthly and recorded in the Fire Logbook.

- The log will include:
    - Date and time of the drill
    - Names of staff and children present
    - Outcome and observations from the drill

**Emergency Shelter Location:**

- In the event of a fire or another emergency requiring evacuation, children and staff will take shelter at the **Eramosa Café at 185 Main St. South, Rockwood, ON**, located north of the school. The owner of the Café has provided verbal consent for this arrangement.
- This location allows staff to **account for all children** and provide temporary care if the school must remain vacant for an extended period.

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## POLICIES AND PROCEDURES REVIEW AND COMPLIANCE POLICY

**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Purpose:**

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that all staff, volunteers, and students review each policy and procedure so they are aware of their roles and responsibilities and are equipped to provide for the health, safety, and well-being of the children in their care.

**Policy Review:**

- Each staff member or volunteer must read and understand each policy and procedure.
- Policies will be reviewed with the **Supervisor** annually, before the commencement of the school year, and whenever a policy is updated during the year.
- The Supervisor will maintain a record of all reviews completed by staff, volunteers, and students. Documentation will be kept on file at the school.

**Policies and Procedures to be Reviewed Include:**

- **Anaphylactic Policy** – reviewed annually and whenever a student with an Individualized Action Plan is enrolled
- **Sanitary Practices Policy** – reviewed annually
- **Serious Occurrence Policy** – reviewed annually
- **Medication Policy** – reviewed annually
- **Supervision of Volunteers and Students Policy** – reviewed annually
- **Program Statement Implementation Policy** – ongoing review
- **Staff Training and Development Policy** – reviewed annually
- **Criminal Reference Check Policy** – reviewed annually
- **Fire Safety and Evacuation Policy** – reviewed annually
- **Behavior Management Policy** – ongoing review
- **Code of Ethics** – reviewed annually

**Compliance Monitoring:**

- The **Supervisor** is responsible for monitoring staff, volunteers, and students regarding adherence to all policies and procedures.
- If non-compliance is identified, the Supervisor will:

1. Document the compliance or non-compliance, including the date, details of the occurrence, and any actions to be taken.
2. Review the policy or procedure with the staff member, volunteer, or student to ensure understanding.
3. Record the discussion, including the time, date, and signatures of all parties involved.

**If non-compliance is severe or repeated:**

- Volunteers may be asked to discontinue their participation.
- Staff issues will be reported to the President of the Board for further action.

- All records of compliance and non-compliance will be kept confidential in the filing cabinet and retained for three years.

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## PARENT ISSUES AND CONCERNS POLICY AND PROCEDURES

**Date Established: July 2017**
**Date Reviewed: July 2026**

**Purpose:**
The purpose of this policy is to provide a clear and transparent process for parents/guardians and Nursery School staff to follow when a parent/guardian has an issue or complaint. Parents and guardians are encouraged to take an active role in Rockwood Nursery School and to discuss their child's experiences in the program.

In alignment with our program statement, we support positive and responsive interactions among children, parents/guardians, and staff. We foster ongoing engagement and communication with parents/guardians about the program and their children. Staff are available and encouraged to have conversations with parents/guardians regarding the program and their child's participation.
All issues and concerns raised by parents/guardians are taken seriously and will be addressed. Every effort will be made to resolve issues promptly and to the satisfaction of all parties.

- Issues or concerns may be submitted verbally or in writing**.**
- Responses or outcomes will be provided verbally, or in writing if requested**.**
- The level of detail shared will respect the confidentiality of all parties involved.
- An **i**nitial response will be provided within two business days**.**
- The person who raised the concern will be kept informed throughout the resolution process.
- Investigations will be fair, impartial, and respectful to all parties involved**.**

**Confidentiality:**
All issues or concerns will be treated confidentially. Every effort will be made to protect the privacy of parents/guardians, children, staff, students, and volunteers. Information will only be disclosed when required by law, such as to:

- The Ministry of Education
- The College of Early Childhood Educators
- Law enforcement
- Children's Aid Society

**Conduct:**
Rockwood Nursery School maintains high standards for positive interaction, communication, and role modeling for children. Harassment or discrimination will not be tolerated from any party.

- If at any time a parent/guardian or staff member feels uncomfortable, threatened, abused, or belittled, they may end the conversation immediately and report the situation to the Supervisor or President.

**Concerns about Suspected Abuse or Neglect of a Child:**

- All members of the public and professionals who work with children are legally required to report suspected abuse or neglect.
- If a parent/guardian expresses concern that a child is being neglected or abused, they will be advised to contact the local Children's Aid Society directly**.**
- Refer to the *Abuse and Neglect Policy and Procedures* for further guidance.

| **Nature of Issue or Concern** | **Steps for Parent Guardian to Report** | **Steps for staff/licensee** |
|---|---|---|
| Program related<br>e.g.: schedule, toileting, indoor/outdoor activities, feeding | Raise the issue or concern to<br>-the classroom staff directly or the supervisor/president | -Address the issue/concern at the time the issue is raised<br>or<br>-arrange a meeting with the parents/guardians within 2 business days<br>-Document the issues/concerns in detail<br>-Documentation should include<br>• the date, time the issue/concern was received<br>• the name of the person who received the issue/concern |
| General, Center Based, Operations Related:<br>e.g.: childcare fees, hours of operation, staffing, waiting lists | Raise the issue or concern with the supervisor/president | |
| Staff, Supervisor and or Licensee Related | Raise the concern to<br>• The individual directly<br>• or Supervisor/President<br>All issues or concerns about the conduct of staff/volunteers etc. that puts a child's health, safety, and wellbeing at risk should be reported to the supervisor as a soon as parents/guardians become aware of the situation | |
| Student/Volunteer Related | Raise the issue or concern to the<br>• staff responsible for supervising the volunteer/student<br>• or the supervisor<br>*Any concerns about the conduct of students/ volunteers that puts a child's safety, health wellbeing at risk will be reported to the supervisor as soon as parents/guardians become aware of the situation. | |

**Escalation of Issues or Concerns:**
Where parents/guardians are not satisfied with the response or outcome of a situation they may escalate the issue or concern verbally or in writing to:

- Issues/concerns related to compliance with requirements set out in the Child Care and Early Years Act 2014 and Ontario Regulation 137/15 should be reported to the Ministry of Education's Child Care Quality Assurance and Licensing Branch.
- Issues/Concerns may also be reported to other relevant regulatory services e.g., Local public health, College of Early Childhood Educators, Ministry of the environment, Ministry of Labor, fire department, Ontario College of teachers, Social Workers etc.

**Contacts:**
**Rockwood Nursery School- 519-856-4486**
**Supervisor:** Ashley Cypcarz- contact information will be provided upon request
**President:** Taryn Lovell -contact information will be provided upon request
**Local Health Department Complaints Line email:** childcareinquiries@wellington.ca
**Child Care Information Line:** 519-837-3620 ext. 3095 or 1 800-265-7294 ext. 3095
**Ministry of Education; Licensed Child Care Help Desk:** 1-877-510-5333

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